08 BATHROOM TILE

THE LUXURY OUTHOUSE & SHOWER

Tile (or tadelakt) that stays waterproof for decades.

LEVEL	CREW	WHERE	STAGE NOW
■■□ Some skill or supervision	1–2	The small shed behind the kitchen	Prep + layout

The small shed behind the kitchen becomes the luxury outhouse and shower. Tile only lasts if what's behind it is right: a solid backer, a waterproof layer, and a floor that slopes to the drain. The plumbing and hot water (see Guide 11) need to be in before the walls are closed.

FIRST STEPS *today*

1. Measure the walls and floor in square feet. Add 10–15% for cuts and breakage.
2. Check the walls are solid and flat (a long straightedge; gaps over about ⅛ in need fixing).
3. Confirm with Yusuf that the plumbing, valves and drain are in and tested.
4. Dry-lay tile on the floor from a center line to plan the cuts. Avoid slivers smaller than half a tile at the edges.
5. Screw a level ledger board one tile up from the floor on each wall. Wall tile starts from there; the floor goes in last.

BEFORE YOU START

- Cutting tile makes silica dust. Cut wet (wet saw) or outside, and wear an N95 or better.
- Thinset and grout are caustic. Gloves and glasses.
- Knee pads. Tiling is hours on your knees.

THE BASICS

The layers	1. Solid, flat backer: cement board, not drywall or plywood. 2. Waterproofing: a roll-on liquid membrane (RedGard, Hydro Ban) or a sheet membrane (Schluter Kerdi). 3. Thinset mortar. 4. Tile. 5. Grout, then sealer.
Floor slope	The shower floor slopes ¼ in per foot toward the drain.
Corners	Where walls meet walls or floor, use flexible silicone caulk, not grout. Grout cracks there.
The traditional option	Tadelakt: Moroccan polished lime plaster, made waterproof with olive-oil black soap. It matches Hira's earthen materials. A mix works well: tadelakt walls, zellige or tile floor and accents.

THE PLAN *in order*

01	**Prep**	Backer board, seams taped and mudded.
02	**Waterproof**	Membrane on, cured per the label.
03	**Flood test**	Plug the drain, fill the shower pan, wait 24–72 hours, check for leaks.

04	**Layout**	Chalk and laser lines, dry-lay.
05	**Set**	Walls first (from the ledger), floor last.
06	**Grout**	After 24 hours.
07	**Seal + caulk**	Seal after about 72 hours; silicone at the corners.

TOOLS & MATERIALS

Notched trowel (size on the tile box) · Drill + mixing paddle, buckets · Spacers or leveling clips · Wet saw or snap cutter, tile nippers · Grout float, sponges · Level, chalk line or laser · Knee pads, gloves, N95, glasses

FOR YUSUF TO DECIDE

- ? Tile or tadelakt (or both)
- ? Tile and color (lapis blue?)
- ? Linear or center drain
- ? A wall niche for soap